

Outlook

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New column, renamed field or changed meaning?

Hi all,

I may be joining dots that do not belong together, so please challenge the premise.

Data Engineering sees changing schemas and needs to distinguish safe expansion from business-definition drift. The discussion is currently being driven by anecdotes, and the teams involved are describing the same customers differently.

Could the answer be that renamed or recoded fields break history? Or are we actually seeing that new fields are additive? I also do not want us to miss the possibility that null patterns reveal a source rollout rather than missing customer data.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use August 2020 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The practical decision is the data contract, quarantine rule and backfill requirement. Please send a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review; I need the exceptions and counter-examples, not only an average.

Work from monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; monthly customer and KYC snapshots; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; the latest closed loan files available by the request date, including affordability, pricing and origination risk fields. A technical schema match does not prove semantic consistency; business owners must confirm meaning.

Regards